

JIANLIN WANG

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Education	University of California, Berkeley , Berkeley, CA <i>Doctor of Philosophy in Economics</i> George Break and Helen Schnacke Break Endowed Fellowship in Economics Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award (Top 10% of GSIs)	Summer 2017 – May 2023
	Massachusetts Institute of Technology , Cambridge, MA <i>Advanced Study Program</i>	Spring 2015 – Fall 2015
	University of Michigan , Ann Arbor, MI <i>Bachelor of Science in Honors Economics and Mathematics</i> Graduated with the Highest Distinction	Fall 2011 – Spring 2014
	Central Michigan University , Mt. Pleasant, MI Transferred to University of Michigan	Spring 2010 – Summer 2011

Areas Macro-Finance, International, Corporate Finance, Banking.

Published & Working Papers [Business Complexity and Risk Management: Evidence from Operational Risk Events in U.S. Bank Holding Companies](#) (with Anna Chernobai and Ali Ozdagli). *Journal of Monetary Economics*, 117 (2021): 418-440.

Abstract: Recent regulatory proposals tie a financial institution's systemic importance to its complexity. However, little is known about how complexity affects banks' risk management. Using the 1996–1999 deregulations of U.S. banks' nonbanking activities as a natural experiment, we show that banks' business complexity increases their operational risk. This result is driven by banks that had been constrained by regulations, compared with other banks and also with nonbank financial institutions that were never subject to these regulations. We provide evidence that managerial failure underlying these events offsets benefits of strategic risk taking.

[Multinationals and Uncertainty: The Role of Internal Capital Markets](#). 2025.

Abstract: Despite their importance, we know little about how the internal capital markets (ICMs) of multinational enterprises (MNEs) connect external lenders. My paper addresses this gap by studying the interaction between parent- and subsidiary-level external lenders. I first derive the optimal debt structure of MNEs, explaining the role of subsidiary-level external debt. When used to incentivize delegated monitoring, I show that MNEs can substitute it with cheaper parent-level external debt to offset deleveraging pressure from local shocks that enhance the monitoring incentives. Using Brexit uncertainty as a natural experiment, I provide evidence of this channel at both parent and subsidiary levels.

[Uncertainty, Stock Prices, and Debt Structure](#) (with Ali Ozdagli). 2025. R&R, *Management Science*.

Abstract: Despite the recognized importance of debt structure in transmitting economic shocks, we know little about its role in transmitting uncertainty. We find that bank debt reduces stock price sensitivity to policy uncertainty, unlike non-bank debt. This mitigating effect comes from cash-flow insolvent firms, consistent with the idea that they particularly value renegotiability of bank debt. We use high-frequency methods to address challenges in identifying policy uncertainty shocks, focusing on the 2018-2019 U.S.-China trade policy uncertainty and the monetary policy uncertainty around FOMC announcements. Our results suggest that bank debt provides insurance and flexibility for shareholders of distressed firms, especially during uncertain times.

[The Anti-Competitive Effect of Input Tariff Liberalization](#) (with Petr Martynov and Yipei Zhang). 2025.

Abstract: This paper studies the welfare implications of input tariff liberalization in a model featuring firm heterogeneity in both exposure and responses to input tariff shocks. We show that this setting gives rise to a new anti-competitive effect that dampens the benchmark welfare gains from trade liberalization. We derive a sufficient statistic for this anti-competitive effect in a general environment: the correlation between firm market shares and their cost shares of imported inputs. The interplay between import intensiveness and market power implies that larger firms benefit more from input tariff cuts while passing through less of the cost reductions, leading to increased aggregate markup dispersion. We empirically test this framework using granular regulatory data from Colombia around its 2010 trade reform. The data covers the universe of firm-level inputs, both imported and domestically sourced, allowing us to disentangle firm-specific exposure and responses to input tariff shocks. Our quantitative analysis demonstrates that input tariff liberalization induces a substantial anti-competitive effect, comparable in magnitude to the pro-competitive effects in the studied episode.

[Parent Company Debt and Subsidiary Bank's Risk-taking: Evidence from Large Bank Holding Companies](#) (with Kebin Ma, David Skeie, and Jing Ye). 2025.

Abstract: We investigate the influence of the parent company's capital structure of a bank holding company's (BHC) on the risk-taking behavior of its subsidiary banks, taking into account the BHC's organizational structure. Our analysis shows that increased parent debt is associated with reduced risk-taking by subsidiary banks. This effect is particularly prominent in BHCs with significant non-bank business, which would give the parent company greater incentives to constrain risk-taking in the subsidiary bank to prevent any spillover of loss. These findings highlight the need to consider the capital structures of the subsidiary, the parent, and the overall BHC—as well as the organizational structure—when assessing a subsidiary bank's risk profile.

[Anticipation Effects and Fiscal Multipliers: Evidence from WWII](#) (with Abhi Gupta). 2023.

Abstract: Correctly estimating fiscal multipliers depends on correctly recording when news of future spending breaks. The leading approach from Ramey (2011) deals with this issue by constructing fiscal shocks using news articles on defense spending. As an alternative, we construct a new measure of excess returns on military contractors over 1936-1947. Excess returns systematically lead the defense news series and produce more persistent dynamic responses of output and government spending. We estimate a long-run fiscal multiplier of 0.7. We consider two explanations for these discrepancies in the context of WWII: slow-moving changes in public expectations and private, pre-war coordination between defense-related firms and the government. For the first, we show that controlling for pre-war expectations of future spending renders both the news series and excess returns poor predictors of government spending. For the second, lagging (leading) the excess returns (defense news) series can approximately reproduce the impulse responses generated by the other, suggesting that firms' returns are measuring the same eventual spending as the defense news series but are responding earlier in time.

Work in Progress **Inventories and Monetary Policy Transmission** (with Marco Brianti and Vito Cormun). Formal draft forthcoming.

Cross-Border Monetary Policy Spillovers and Internal Capital Markets of Firms
(with Björn Imbierowicz and Xiaoyu Liu).

[Multinationals and Exchange Rates: Evidence from Switzerland](#). Clausen Center 2022 Research Grant Award.

Other Publications [Does Corporate Debt Structure Affect Stock Prices during Uncertain Times?](#) (with Ali Ozdagli). 2022. Berkeley Economics Newsroom.

[Firm Debt Structure Can Mitigate Impact of Uncertainty Shock](#) (with Ali Ozdagli and Sona Shah). 2022. FRB Dallas Economics Blog.

Predoctoral Research

[The Household Level Impact of Public Health Insurance: Evidence from the Urban Resident Basic Medical Insurance in China](#). 2014. Senior Thesis with High Honors.

Distributional Impacts of the Minnesota Family Investment Program. 2013. A+ Paper for the Evaluation of Social and Educational Program Seminar at University of Michigan.

Work Experience

Leavey School of Business, Santa Clara University, Santa Clara, CA
Assistant Professor of Economics September 2023 – Present

Haas School of Business, U.C. Berkeley, Berkeley, CA
Graduate Student Instructor
 Macroeconomics in the Global Economy (MBA Core) Spring 2022 (Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas)

Department of Economics, U.C. Berkeley, Berkeley, CA
Graduate Student Researcher
 Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas Summer 2018, Spring 2021
 Maurice Obstfeld Spring 2019 – Spring 2021
 Yuriy Gorodnichenko Summer 2018

Graduate Student Instructor
 International Monetary Economics Fall 2020 (P.O. Gourinchas), Fall 2021 (M. Obstfeld)
 Financial Economics Fall 2018 – Spring 2020 (Raymond Hawkins)

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, Boston, MA
Senior Research Assistant for Ali Ozdagli and Federico Diez Summer 2014 – Summer 2017

Presentations

2026: ASSA Annual Meeting; MFA Annual Meeting (2 sessions scheduled)

2025: CEBRA Annual Meeting (Harvard Business School); WEAI Annual Conference; SNDE Annual Symposium (UT San Antonio); CES North America Conference (Umich Ross School of Business); 38th Australasian Finance and Banking Conference (UNSW Business School, scheduled); Beijing Capital University of Economics and Business

2024: SFA Annual Meeting; Federal Reserve Bank of Boston; Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas; Warwick Business School Brown Bag Series; CES North America Conference (Bucknell); Leavey Research Seminar Series (SCU); SCU Econ

2023: Stanford SITE (Session: The Macroeconomics of Uncertainty and Volatility); SCU Econ; Cornerstone Research; Warwick Business School; UC Berkeley

Awards & Fellowships

Corporate Sustainability Research Grant	Leavey School of Business, Santa Clara University
Leavey School of Business Research Grant	Santa Clara University
Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award (Top 10% of GSIs)	Dept. of Economics, UCB
George Break and Helen Schnacke Break Endowed Fellowship in Economics	U.C. Berkeley
Clausen Center 2022 Research Grant	Clausen Center for Intl. Business and Policy
2020 Stanford Big Data Initiative in International Macro-Finance	Dept. of Economics, Stanford
2019 Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money, and Finance	Dept. of Economics, Princeton
Clausen Center Fellowship	Clausen Center for Intl. Business and Policy
First-Year Fellowship & Departmental Fellowship	Dept. of Economics, UCB
Service Quality Award	Federal Reserve Bank of Boston
Graduated with the Highest Distinction	University of Michigan
Senior Thesis with High Honors	Dept. of Economics, University of Michigan
Outstanding Achievement in Mathematics	Dept. of Mathematics, University of Michigan

Harold D. Osterweil Memorial Prize Nominee
President's List and Dean's List (All semesters)

Dept. of Economics, University of Michigan
Central Michigan University

Memberships

American Economic Association; American Finance Association; Southern Finance Association; Phi Kappa Phi; Phi Eta Sigma; National Society of Leadership and Success; National Society of Collegiate Scholars; Golden Key International Honour Society

Programming

Stata/Mata, Python, Matlab, VBA, C++, $\text{\LaTeX}$

References

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David Sraer	+1 (510) 642-8363	sraer@berkeley.edu
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Ali Ozdagli	+1 (617) 784-8574	ali.ozdagli@dal.frb.org

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